THREE FINGER PLUCKING

Program

BLOCK 2 — fretting & plucking finger independence

01 Four against three

a = ring
m = middle
i = index
1-4 = fretting

BLOCK 2

Program

Block 2 adds the fretting hand. The plucking hand keeps the strict **a–m–i** cycle from Block 1, and the fretting hand plays a four-note shape that goes up and back. Four against three means the hands line up only every twelve notes, so each fretted note is played with every plucking finger before the pattern repeats.

The fretting hand stays in 8th-fret position, one finger per fret: index on the 8th fret, pinky on the 11th. Fretting fingers are the numbers above the staff; plucking fingers stay between the staves.

The fretting shape turns around at its top and bottom notes. The plucking cycle never does, so at those turns the hands move in opposite directions. The usual error there is a reflexive **m** where the cycle calls for **i** or **a**. Keep the cycle strict and let the hands disagree.

PIMA p = thumb (pulgar) · i = index (índice) · m = middle (medio) · a = ring (anular)
LH 1 = index · 2 = middle · 3 = ring · 4 = pinky

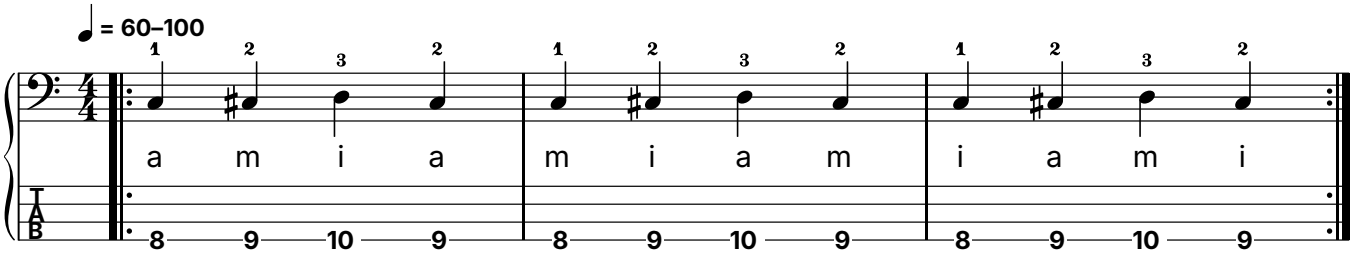
EXERCISE 1

Block II

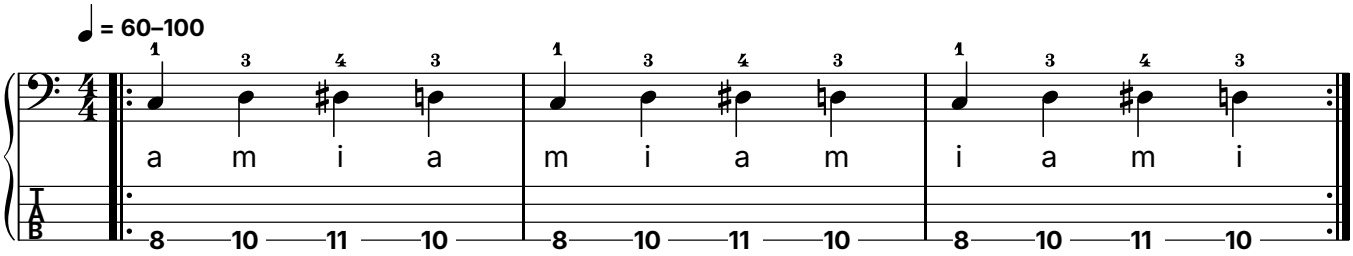
Exercise 1 runs a four-note fretting shape on the E string against the a–m–i cycle: C, C#, D, C#, and around again. Twelve notes, three bars of quarter notes, bring both hands back to their starting fingers, and the repeat returns you to C on **a**. Each variation moves the shape to another set of three fretting fingers. Variation #4 leaves out the index finger, so the ring and pinky carry it. Drop to half notes or a slower tempo until the cycle holds through every turn.

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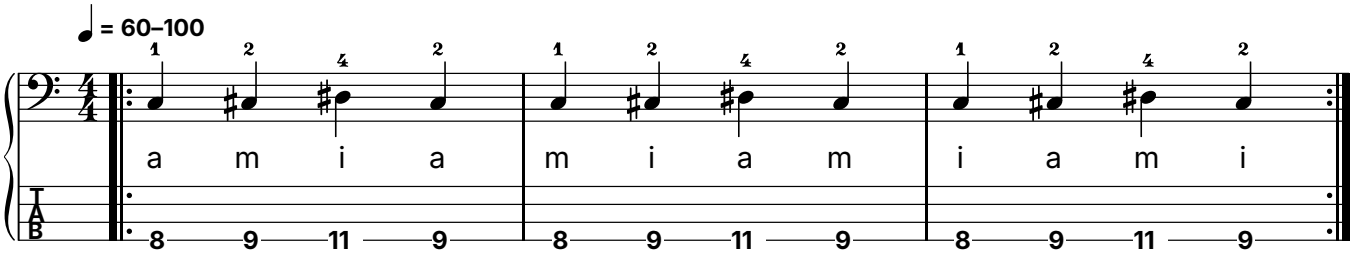
Variation #1: Fingers 1-2-3 (C, C#, D)



Variation #2: Fingers 1-3-4 (C, D, D#)



Variation #3: Fingers 1-2-4 (C, C#, D#)



Variation #4: Fingers 2-3-4 (C#, D, D#)

